



Partly sunny 56/41 • Tomorrow: Shower 57/54 B18

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, JANUARY 8, 2026 • \$4

# Woman is fatally shot by ICE in Minnesota

Agency says officer acted in self-defense; some in Congress call it ‘murder’

This article is by *Caroline O’Donovan, Maria Sacchetti, Jonathan Baran, Aaron C. Davis and Annie Gowen*

A U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer on Wednesday fatally shot a 37-year-old woman during an operation in Minneapolis, federal authorities said, a killing that drew outrage from local officials already angered by the Trump administration’s massive enforcement effort in the city.

President Donald Trump and the Department of Homeland Security said the officer feared for his safety and was acting in self-defense after the woman threatened him with her vehicle. But state and national Democrats repudiated that claim — which Minneapolis Mayor Jacob Frey called “bullshit” — accusing the administration of recklessness and demanding an end to the immigration operations.

On social media, some members of Congress described the killing as “murder” and called for federal officials to be held accountable. Hundreds of people gathered for a vigil at the scene Wednesday evening.

“This was an agent recklessly using power that resulted in somebody dying, getting killed,”

SEE MINNEAPOLIS ON A6

# New dietary advice favors whole milk and red meat

Guidelines warn against processed food, artificial sweeteners, added sugar

BY RACHEL ROUBEIN

The Trump administration released new dietary guidelines Wednesday that call for Americans to limit highly processed foods, such as those high in added sugars and sodium, and that endorse products that had once been discouraged by many nutritionists, such as whole milk, butter and red meat.

The recommendations emphasize eating whole foods — such as fruits and vegetables in their original forms — and foods rich in protein and whole grains. They call for avoiding packaged, prepared or other ready-to-eat foods that are salty or sweet — such as many chips, candies and cookies — as well as staying away from sugar-sweetened beverages like sodas, fruit drinks and energy drinks and some artificial sweeteners.

Under the guidelines, Americans should eat three servings of dairy products a day and include full fat without added sugar, a shift from decades of advising Americans to favor skim and low-fat options over whole milk. They should eat ample protein, from animal and plant sources — including red meats nutritionists had long told Americans to limit. They should have no more than 10 grams of added sugar per meal,

SEE FOOD ON A7



TIM EVANS/REUTERS

Border Patrol agents use chemical irritants to disperse a crowd Wednesday in Minneapolis at the scene of the shooting.

# On Musk’s X, AI-generated sexualized images proliferate

BY TATUM HUNTER

Ashley St. Clair, a conservative influencer, had just put her baby down for the night Sunday when she got a text from a friend that turned her weekend into a nightmare: People on X were using the app’s chatbot, Grok, to generate sexual images of her, including one based on a photo of St. Clair at 14 years old.

It isn’t St. Clair’s first run-in with X or its owner, Elon Musk — the 27-year-old is embroiled in a legal battle with Musk over custo-

Users have been asking chatbot Grok to undress women and children

dy of their 1-year-old son — but it is the first time she felt completely helpless to defend herself, she said. When she flagged posts depicting her in sexualized outfits and poses to X, the platform deleted some of them and responded that others didn’t violate

any guidelines.

“I’m not speaking as Elon Musk’s baby mama with some special privilege,” she said. “I’m going through the same avenues as everyone else, and this is what I’m getting.”

St. Clair is one of a growing number of women and girls who have been digitally “undressed” by Grok in recent days, as users prompt the chatbot to show subjects in lingerie, covered in liquid, or with black eyes or fearful expressions. Some of the images appear to portray children, The

Washington Post found. Despite callouts from high-profile victims including St. Clair, X hasn’t stopped Grok from generating explicit images.

The latest spate of such images has given new weight to accusations by watchdog groups, women’s advocates and foreign governments that the social media company is playing fast and loose with artificial intelligence while other companies enforce stricter guardrails.

After she posted about what

SEE GROK ON A6



Jannique Spriggs, who was serving with D.C. police during the Capitol riot, recalled worrying: “Are we going to get out?” Carlton Wilhoit III, another D.C. officer, left the force for the Peace Corps.



PHOTOS BY LEAH MILLIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

# Five years after the riot, scars linger

In their own words, officers tell of the day’s violence and its lasting effects

BY DARANEE BALACHANDAR, ELLIE SILVERMAN AND AMY BRITTAIN

After the tear gas cleared and the glass was swept up and the blood and feces were scrubbed off the walls, the Capitol returned to the business of democracy, and most of the officers who had defended it on Jan. 6, 2021, went back to work.

Some were bruised, scratched and sprayed with chemicals. Several were knocked unconscious. Some suffered traumatic brain injuries and underwent surgeries. Some were diagnosed with PTSD. Many kept showing up to work with nerves that felt jangled and bodies that hurt in ways they hadn’t before.

Five years after the Capitol attack, most of the officers injured that day have never widely shared their experience. To understand the effects of one of the most divisive days in American history on the people who lived it, The Washington Post,

referencing a database from the Chicago Project on Security and Threats, contacted 58 current and former officers from D.C. police, U.S. Capitol Police, Metro Transit Police, Arlington County police and Prince George’s County police.

Many officers never reported their injuries, The Post learned. The most frequently cited number of injured officers — 140 — is probably an undercount. The Office of Government Accountability has tallied at least 174.

Many stayed in law enforcement. But some retired early. Others moved away, one as far as New Zealand, to avoid reminders of being attacked. They left for psychology, education, the Peace Corps. Some were too injured to work.

Most did not respond or declined to be inter-

SEE JAN. 6 ON A8

# Europe draws a red line on threats to Greenland

After a year of trying to pacify Trump, leaders join in forceful rebukes

BY STEVE HENDRIX

LONDON — For the past year, European friends turned frenemies of the United States have delicately navigated one shock after another, hoping for the best as President Donald Trump threatened to lay waste to the global order.

When Trump scolded NATO allies, lambasted Ukraine’s president, laid on tariffs and framed ratified treaties as conditional deals, the go-to play by European leaders was to placate — with military spending pledges, trade concessions and disciplined summits, in language scrubbed of morality or judgment.

It wasn’t always elegant or dignified, but the policy of strategic acquiescence seemed to be working, sort of. U.S. arms kept flowing to Ukraine, an all-out trade war was averted and Trump declined to say some nice things about NATO.

Then came the strikes that rocked Caracas, explosions that echoed in capitals around the world. Governments that spent years preaching restraint, legality and multilateralism found themselves scrambling for words to express unease without triggering Trump’s fury.

The precarious strategy of managing Trump, rather than confronting him, looked more

exposed when the president and his inner circle revived their talk of “getting” Greenland and even floated the idea of military action. To European ears, it sounded less like bluster than a retrograde worldview now backed by unvarnished American might: power over process, leverage over law, loyalty conditioned on utility.

“It’s approaching a full-on existential crisis,” said Mujtaba Rahman, managing director for Europe at political risk consultancy Eurasia Group. “It could be far greater than Russia invading Ukraine, because Russia is an adversary. Now, it’s the guarantor of European security undermining European security.”

Where many European leaders’ reactions to the Venezuela raid were muted, caveated or outsourced to legal abstractions about the United Nations Charter, European leaders on Tuesday came out with uncommonly forceful rebukes of the Trump administration’s greediness on Greenland.

The prime minister of Denmark, a NATO member, said a U.S. action on Greenland, a territory of the kingdom of Denmark for more than 300 years, would be the end of the alliance. Leaders of France, Germany, Italy, Poland, Spain and Britain closed ranks with Copenhagen, issuing a joint statement that Greenland’s future is a matter for “Denmark and Greenland, and them only.”

Denmark and Greenland have

SEE EUROPE ON A13

**Greenland’s appeal:** Why Trump wants it, and what’s in his way. **A10**

## IN THE NEWS

**Killings at Brown University** The suspect in the campus shooting admitted to planning the attack for months, according to a video transcript released by authorities. **A3**

**Texas teachers** A new lawsuit alleges that 350 educators in the state were targeted for posts having to do with Charlie Kirk. **A3**

**THE NATION** **Iowa is gaining** more say in spending federal education funds. **A2** **An election** to fill the House seat vacated by Marjorie Taylor Greene (R-Georgia) will be held March 10. **A4**

**THE WORLD** **Saudi Arabia’s allies** in Yemen ousted a UAE-backed separatist leader from power. **A12** **U.S. action** in Venezuela could embolden Russia in asserting its own sphere of dominance. **A12**

**THE ECONOMY** **Higher prices** and more expansive floor plans are boxing out many shoppers in the market for entry-level homes. **A14** **U.S. employers** posted far fewer jobs in November than in the previous month, new federal data shows. **A14**

**STYLE** **“The Pitt,”** HBO’s hospital-set drama, returns with less adrenaline, but it’s no less riveting. **B1**

**SPORTS** **The CFP semifinals** start with tonight’s Fiesta Bowl, and we should all be rooting for Ole Miss and Indiana, writes Candace Buckner. **B7**

**THE REGION** **In an unprecedented** situation, the D.C. Council will select an interim member to serve until a special election can be held. **B13**

**LOCAL LIVING** **Rack up** some easy wins with our list of 20 things to declutter right now to start the year lighter.

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